

Midterm Preparation Pack

Part 1 — A universal impromptu speech template (just drop the topic in) | Part 2 — 10 board questions with full answers | Part 3 — One-page revision sheet

WHAT YOU ARE GIVEN	WHAT YOU MUST PRODUCE	MARKS
Part 1 — A topic	An impromptu speech, written in the 3-part structure: Introduction → Body → Conclusion . Use the template in Part 1 of this pack and substitute the topic.	7
Part 2 — Board questions	Written answers from Ch.1 Communication Perspectives (5 types of context), Ch.2 Ethics (ethical guidelines of speaking & how to improve them), and Ch.3 Nonverbal Messages (3 types of nonverbal communication).	—

THE ONE RULE THAT MAKES THE TEMPLATE UNIVERSAL

Everywhere you see the yellow chip **[TOPIC]**, write the exact topic the examiner gives you. Everywhere you see a dotted blank _____, add *one* small detail of your own (an example, a word, a real-life fact). Nothing else changes. The skeleton, the transitions, and the conclusion stay the same for every topic.

PART ONE · 7 MARKS

The Universal Impromptu Speech Template

Built from your ENG111 Impromptu Speech Guidelines and the sample speech "The Importance of Volunteering".

1.1 What the examiner is checking

An impromptu speech is delivered without prior notice or preparation: you receive a topic, you get a few minutes to organise your ideas, and then you present them clearly, confidently, and logically. According to the ENG111 guidelines, an effective impromptu speech is *not* about speaking perfectly — it is about **organising your thoughts quickly, communicating your ideas clearly, and speaking with confidence**. So the examiner is looking for structure, not genius. Make these six things visible on your answer paper:

1. A **catchy attention-grabber** in the first line.
2. A **clear thesis statement** — one sentence saying what your main message is.
3. **Two to three body points**, each with an explanation *and* a supporting example.
4. **Transition words** between the points (*First... Moreover... Finally...*).
5. A **conclusion** that restates the thesis, summarises, and closes — with **no new idea** introduced.
3. Length that fits a **2 – 2.5 minute** speech (roughly 350–420 words).

1.2 Your preparation note card (5 minutes)

The guidelines say: **use keywords or short notes — do not try to memorise sentences**. Jot down only the key points, no description or elaboration. Copy this exact grid onto your rough sheet the moment you see the topic:

ROUGH-WORK NOTE CARD — FILL THIS IN 60 SECONDS

TOPIC: _____

THESIS (my one main message): _____

Point 1 — ME / the individual → example: _____

Point 2 — SOCIETY / other people → example: _____

Point 3 — FUTURE / what we should do → example: _____

CLOSING LINE: _____

1.3 Choose your engine (10-second decision)

The three body points are the only part of a speech that really depends on the topic. Pick one of these three "engines" and the rest of the template stays identical.

ENGINE	USE IT WHEN THE TOPIC IS...	THE THREE BODY POINTS BECOME
A — SELF → SOCIETY → FUTURE (the default)	a thing, value or quality — a noun. <i>"The Importance of Volunteering", "Reading Books", "Honesty", "Time Management", "Technology in Education"</i>	1. How it affects me as an individual 2. How it affects society / the community 3. How it shapes the future , and what we should do
B — STAND → REASON → COUNTER	a question or "Do you agree?" <i>"Should mobile phones be allowed in class?", "Is failure a better teacher than success?"</i>	1. My stand + my strongest reason 2. My second reason + example 3. "Some may argue... However..." (answer the other side)
C — PROBLEM → EFFECT → SOLUTION	a problem or issue . <i>"Traffic jam in Dhaka", "Air pollution", "Exam pressure", "Unemployment"</i>	1. The problem and its causes 2. Its effects on people and society 3. What can be done about it

IF YOU FREEZE IN THE EXAM HALL

Use **Engine A**. Self → Society → Future fits almost every topic that has ever been set, including question topics and problem topics. It is the safe default, and it is the engine the template below is written on.

1.4 The template — copy this structure exactly

Write the bold labels on your answer script too. They show the examiner that you know the required 3-part structure.

UNIVERSAL IMPROMPTU SPEECH — ENGINE A (SELF → SOCIETY → FUTURE)	
TOPIC	"....." (copy the topic exactly as given)
1 · Introduction (30–40 seconds)	
ATTENTION-GRABBER	"How many of us have ever stopped and thought about how much [TOPIC] really shapes our everyday life?"
INTRODUCTION	"I can tell you from my own experience that [TOPIC] is something we all meet in daily life, and yet we rarely stop to think about its real value. In today's fast-paced world, it is easy to focus only on our own responsibilities and challenges. However, when we look a little closer, we see that [TOPIC] affects not only the individual but also the society around them. Today, I want to talk about why [TOPIC] matters far more than we usually realise."
THESIS	"[TOPIC] is not just (a small thing / a personal habit / an ordinary part of life); it shapes us as individuals, it strengthens our society, and it decides the kind of future we build."
2 · Body (1.5–2 minutes — about 30–40 seconds per point)	
POINT 1 — THE INDIVIDUAL	"First, [TOPIC] has a direct effect on us as individuals."
EXPLANATION	"On a personal level, [TOPIC] influences the way we think, the choices we make, and the habits we build every day. When we engage with it seriously, we develop qualities such as discipline, awareness, and confidence. For example , (one short example from your own life, your campus, or your country). Over time, these small personal changes shape our character and improve the quality of our own lives."
POINT 2 — SOCIETY	"Moreover, [TOPIC] plays an important role in our society."

EXPLANATION

"No one lives in isolation — what affects one person eventually affects the whole community. [TOPIC] influences how people work together, how they understand one another, and how problems are solved collectively. **For instance,** (one short social or national example). As a result, its impact travels far beyond the individual and helps shape the environment that all of us share."

POINT 3 — THE FUTURE

"**Finally,** [TOPIC] is closely connected to our future."

EXPLANATION

"The way we deal with [TOPIC] today will decide the kind of future we live in tomorrow. Used wisely, it can open doors to new opportunities, personal growth, and progress; ignored or misused, it can cost us those very chances. This is why awareness, responsibility, and a balanced approach matter so much. Most importantly, it reminds us that a small step taken today can create a lasting difference tomorrow."

3 · Conclusion (30–40 seconds — no new ideas)

RESTATE THESIS

"**So,** [TOPIC] is much more than (repeat the word you used in your thesis) — it shapes individuals, it strengthens communities, and it influences the future we are all walking towards."

SUMMARY

"**In summary,** [TOPIC] affects us personally by shaping our habits and character, socially by influencing the way we live together, and in the long run by deciding the opportunities that will be open to us."

CLOSING THOUGHT

"I encourage each of you to think seriously about the place [TOPIC] holds in your own life. Even a small change in the way we look at it can create a lasting impact — and that is where real change always begins. Thank you."

SWAPPING THE BODY FOR ENGINE B OR ENGINE C

The Introduction and the Conclusion above never change. Only the three **Point + Explanation** pairs change:

- **Engine B (opinion topics):** Point 1 — "First, I firmly believe that [TOPIC] ... and the main reason is". Point 2 — "Moreover,". Point 3 — "Now, some may argue that However, — and that is exactly why my position still stands."
- **Engine C (problem topics):** Point 1 — "First, let us look at the real cause of [TOPIC]". Point 2 — "Moreover, the effects of [TOPIC] reach every one of us." Point 3 — "Finally, the good news is that [TOPIC] is a problem we can act on."

1.5 Sentence bank — memorise these, not whole speeches

FIVE ATTENTION-GRABBERS (CHOOSE ONE)

TYPE	READY-MADE LINE
Question	"Have you ever wondered what life would be like without [TOPIC]?"
Quote / proverb	"They say — but is that always true?"
Mini story	"This morning, on my way to campus, I realised something simple but powerful about [TOPIC]."
Broad → specific	"[TOPIC] has become an essential part of our everyday life. It is now also a crucial part of our education."
Startling statement	"Imagine a single day without [TOPIC]. For most of us, that is almost impossible."

TRANSITIONS (THE MARKS ARE HIDING HERE)

TO...	USE...
Start the body	To begin with... · First... · First of all...
Add a point	Moreover... · Another reason is... · In addition... · Not only that...
Give the last point	Finally... · Lastly... · Most importantly...
Give an example	For example... · For instance... · Let me give you an example...
Show a contrast	However... · On the other hand... · Some may argue that... However...
Show a result	As a result... · Therefore... · This is why...
Signal the ending	To sum up... · In short... · In conclusion... · Ultimately...

THREE CLOSING LINES (CHOOSE ONE)

- **Call to action:** "I encourage each of you to _____ — because even a small step creates a lasting impact."
- **Final thought:** "Because at the end of the day, [TOPIC] is not about _____ — it is about _____."
- **Circle back to your opening:** "So the next time you _____, remember what [TOPIC] really means."

1.6 Worked example — the template with a topic dropped in

Given topic: "The Importance of Time Management". Engine A. Nothing has been rewritten — only the chips and blanks were filled.

FILLED EXAMPLE

ATTENTION-GRABBER

"How many of us have ever stopped and thought about how much **time management** really shapes our everyday life?"

INTRODUCTION

"I can tell you from my own experience that **time management** is something we all meet in daily life, and yet we rarely stop to think about its real value. In today's fast-paced world, it is easy to focus only on our own responsibilities and challenges. However, when we look a little closer, we see that **time management** affects not only the individual but also the society around them. Today, I want to talk about why **time management** matters far more than we usually realise."

THESIS

"**Time management** is not just a **personal habit**; it shapes us as individuals, it strengthens our society, and it decides the kind of future we build."

POINT 1 + EXPLANATION

"**First**, time management has a direct effect on us as individuals. On a personal level, it influences the way we think, the choices we make, and the habits we build every day. When we engage with it seriously, we develop qualities such as discipline, awareness, and confidence. **For example**, *a student who plans her week finishes her assignments calmly, while the student who leaves everything to the last night submits poor work and loses sleep.* Over time, these small personal changes shape our character and improve the quality of our own lives."

POINT 2 + EXPLANATION

"**Moreover**, time management plays an important role in our society. No one lives in isolation — what affects one person eventually affects the whole community. It influences how people work together, how they understand one another, and how problems are solved collectively. **For instance**, *when a hospital, an office, or a public bus service runs on time, hundreds of people benefit; when it does not, the whole city pays the price.* As a result, its impact travels far beyond the individual and helps shape the environment that all of us share."

POINT 3 + EXPLANATION

"**Finally**, time management is closely connected to our future. The way we deal with it today will decide the kind of future we live in tomorrow. Used wisely, it can open doors to new opportunities, personal growth, and progress; ignored or misused, it can cost us those very chances. This is why awareness, responsibility, and a balanced approach matter so much. Most importantly, it reminds us that a small step taken today can create a lasting difference tomorrow."

CONCLUSION (RESTATE + SUMMARY + CLOSING)

"**So**, time management is much more than a **personal habit** — it shapes individuals, it strengthens communities, and it influences the future we are all walking towards. **In summary**, it affects us personally by shaping our habits and character, socially by influencing the way we live together, and in the long run by deciding the opportunities that will be open to us. I encourage each of you to think seriously about the place time management holds in your own life. Even a small change in the way we look at it can create a lasting impact — and that is where real change always begins. Thank you."

THREE MORE TOPICS, PLUGGED STRAIGHT IN

TOPIC GIVEN	ENGINE	THESIS + THE THREE POINTS
Honesty	A	Thesis: Honesty is not just a moral rule; it shapes us as individuals, strengthens our society, and decides the kind of future we build. 1. It builds our own character and self-respect. 2. It creates trust, without which no family, office, or nation functions. 3. An honest generation today means a fair society tomorrow.
Should students do part-time jobs?	B	Thesis: I firmly believe students should be allowed to do part-time jobs, because the experience teaches what no classroom can. 1. It builds responsibility, time management, and financial independence. 2. It gives real-world skills that employers value. 3. <i>Some may argue</i> it harms studies — <i>however</i>, with a limited number of hours, it improves discipline rather than destroying it.
Traffic jam in Dhaka	C	Thesis: The traffic jam in Dhaka is not merely an inconvenience; it is a problem we have created, and one we can still solve. 1. Problem: too many vehicles, weak planning, and undisciplined road use. 2. Effect: lost working hours, pollution, stress, and students reaching class late. 3. Solution: better public transport, stricter enforcement, and citizens obeying traffic rules.

1.7 Timing and length

SECTION	TIME	APPROX. WORDS	CONTAINS
Introduction	30–40 sec	70–90	Attention-grabber + introduction + thesis
Body — Point 1	30–40 sec	70–90	Point + explanation + example
Body — Point 2	30–40 sec	70–90	Point + explanation + example
Body — Point 3	30–40 sec	70–90	Point + explanation + example
Conclusion	30–40 sec	60–80	Restate thesis + summary + closing thought
Total	2 – 2.5 min	350 – 420	Preparation time allowed: 5 minutes

WHAT LOSES MARKS

- **No clear thesis.** If the examiner cannot point to one sentence that states your main message, you lose the easiest marks in the paper.
- **Points without explanation or example.** A bare list is not a speech. Every point needs a fact, a comparison, or a real-life example.
- **No transitions.** Without *First... Moreover... Finally...* the speech reads as disconnected sentences.
- **A new idea in the conclusion.** The guidelines explicitly forbid this. Conclusion = restate, summarise, close. Nothing new.
- **Not actually engaging the topic.** A memorised speech that never mentions the given topic is obvious to an examiner. That is why you must fill in the chips and blanks.
- **Wrong length.** Far too short leaves the structure incomplete; far too long means you cannot finish in 2.5 minutes.

IF YOU ALSO HAVE TO DELIVER IT ALOUD

1. Stand upright and keep good posture; smile at the start to build a positive connection.
2. Speak clearly at a natural pace — do not rush.
3. Be conversational, not monotone: vary pitch, pace, and emphasis; show interest in your topic.
4. Keep regular eye contact with the audience — do not stare at the note card.
5. Use natural hand gestures to emphasise important points.
6. Keep the message simple and logical, and use transitional words for smooth movement between ideas.
7. Share a personal example only if it adds value and fits the time.
8. Put your energy into a strong opening and a memorable conclusion — those are the parts people remember most.

10 Broad Questions with Full Answers

Chapter 1 — Communication Perspectives | Chapter 2 — Ethics & Public Speaking | Chapter 3 — Nonverbal Messages

QUESTION 1 · CHAPTER 1

What is communication? Explain the process of encoding and decoding with examples.

Communication is a **complex process through which we express, interpret, and coordinate messages with others** in order to create shared meaning, meet social goals, manage personal identity, and carry out our relationships. At its core, communication is about **messages** — the verbal utterances, visual images, and nonverbal behaviours we use to convey our thoughts and feelings.

Two mental processes sit at the heart of it:

1. Encoding. Encoding is the process of putting our thoughts and feelings into words and nonverbal behaviours. It is how a speaker *packages* meaning. Effective speakers design their messages with the audience's decoding in mind — that is, they choose words, tone, and gestures that the listener is likely to interpret correctly.

EXAMPLE — A student who wants a deadline extension carefully selects polite words, a respectful tone, and an apologetic facial expression before approaching the teacher. That whole selection process is encoding.

2. Decoding. Decoding is the process of interpreting another person's message. Importantly, people do *not* decode messages the way the sender intended; they decode them through their own frame of reference — their experiences, mood, and culture.

EXAMPLE — The same request may be decoded by the teacher as a sincere explanation, or as a weak excuse, depending on the student's past record and the teacher's own state of mind.

This is why meaning is never simply "sent". Meaning is created jointly: the sender encodes, the receiver decodes, and shared meaning is achieved only when the two match closely. It also answers the classic question — *who decides what a message means?* Both do, but the receiver has the final say.

QUESTION 2 · CHAPTER 1

What are canned plans and scripts? Why are they important in communication?

A **canned plan** is a "mental library" of strategies that each of us draws from to create messages, based on what has worked for us in the past or what we have heard and used many times in similar situations. In other words, a canned plan is a **learned communication strategy for a specific type of situation**.

Canned plans contain **scripts** — sequences of communication behaviours, or specific messages, designed to carry out a plan. Put differently, a script is the actual text of what to say and do in a particular situation. We hold canned plans and scripts for a wide variety of everyday interactions: greeting people, making small talk, giving advice, complimenting, apologising, or persuading others.

How they work. We do not usually build a message from scratch. We recognise the type of message we want to form, search our mental canned-plan library for a suitable script, and then customise it to fit the unique details of the situation. All of this mental choosing happens in nanoseconds and almost automatically. We also use canned plans and scripts when we *interpret* the messages of others.

Why they matter. The larger your canned-plan library and the more scripts you have, the more likely you are to form **appropriate and effective** messages, and the better you will be able to understand and respond appropriately to the messages of others. A speaker with a small script library sounds awkward or inappropriate in unfamiliar situations.

EXAMPLE — When you meet a teacher in the corridor you automatically use a formal greeting script ("Good morning, sir. How are you?"), which is completely different from the script you use with a close friend. Neither was invented on the spot; both were pulled from your mental library and adjusted.

QUESTION 3 · CHAPTER 1 · HIGH-PROBABILITY QUESTION

What is communication context? Explain the FIVE types of communication context with examples.

Communication context refers to the different situations or environments in which communication takes place — that is, the **background conditions surrounding the interaction between people**. Context matters because it *gives meaning* to communication: it influences how messages are delivered, interpreted, and understood, and it shapes the participants' subsequent behaviour. To be an effective communicator, a person must be able to understand the context and adjust when needed. There are five types.

1. Physical Context. The actual setting in which communication takes place. It includes the **location** of the encounter, the **environmental conditions** around it (temperature, lighting, noise level), and the **physical proximity** of the participants. Background noise or poor lighting can cause misunderstanding and distraction, while a comfortable setting encourages effective communication.

EXAMPLE — Communicating in a noisy coffee shop, versus the same conversation in a quiet office, leads to very different levels of understanding and focus.

2. Social Context. The nature of the **relationship that already exists** between the participants. It includes familiarity, status,

authority, and the type of relationship (professional, familial, or casual). The better you know someone and the better your relationship with them, the more accurately you are likely to interpret their message.

EXAMPLE — A conversation between a teacher and a student is very different from a conversation between two friends, because of the social roles involved.

3. Historical Context. The background created by **previous interactions and shared experiences** between the participants. Past conversations shape how current messages are interpreted, and often allow people to communicate efficiently with fewer words. Shared history reduces ambiguity and supports mutual understanding.

EXAMPLE — Anya texts Sam to say she will collect the report he left for their manager. Later, seeing Sam at lunch, she asks, "Did you get it?" Both understand exactly what "it" means, because of their earlier communication.

4. Psychological Context. The **mental and emotional states, attitudes, beliefs, and perceptions** of the individuals involved. These internal factors influence how messages are formed, delivered, and interpreted; a person's emotional state strongly affects the meaning, tone, and intent they perceive.

EXAMPLE — A calm person in a positive mood may interpret a neutral message as harmless, whereas an anxious or upset person may read exactly the same message as negative or critical.

5. Cultural Context. The **beliefs, values, orientations, underlying assumptions, and rituals** that belong to a specific culture. Cultural expectations often define the way messages are communicated, and every culture has its own idea of what is appropriate or inappropriate. Everyone belongs to one or more cultural groups (religion, gender, ethnicity, age, physical ability), so when two people from different cultures interact, misunderstandings may occur because of their different values, beliefs, orientations, and rituals.

EXAMPLE — In some cultures direct eye contact is a sign of respect and confidence; in others, it may be considered confrontational or disrespectful.

QUESTION 4 · CHAPTER 1

Explain the **SEVEN** characteristics of communication.

Communication is a complex and multifaceted process, and it is best understood by examining its key characteristics.

1. Communication has a purpose. Whenever we communicate we have a purpose for doing so. The purpose may be serious or trivial, and we may or may not be aware of it at the time. Whether the goal is to inform, persuade, entertain, express emotions, or build relationships, effective communication is aligned with the communicator's intended objective.

EXAMPLE — In a business meeting, a presentation is designed to inform the team about new strategies; a casual conversation aims to build rapport and connect on a personal level.

2. Communication is continuous. Communication is constant and never truly stops. We are always sending and interpreting messages. Even when we are not actively speaking or writing, we are still communicating through body language, facial expressions, and even silence — silence communicates if another person infers meaning from it.

EXAMPLE — You may sit quietly in a meeting, but your posture, eye contact, and facial expressions still communicate something to those around you.

3. Communication is irreversible. Once an exchange has taken place, we can never go back in time and erase it. We might be able to repair the damage, but the message has already been communicated.

EXAMPLE — You cannot "unsend" an angry text once it has been delivered and read. It may affect the relationship even if you apologise later.

4. Communication is situated. Communication occurs within a specific setting, and that setting heavily influences how messages are produced, interpreted, and coordinated.

EXAMPLE — The interpretation of the statement "I love you" varies completely depending on the setting in which it is said.

5. Communication is indexical. How we communicate is also an index — a measure — of the emotional temperature of our relationship at that moment.

EXAMPLE — As a couple gets into the car for a holiday, the wife says, "I remembered to bring the map." She is not merely reporting information; through her tone of voice and other nonverbal cues she may also be communicating "You can always depend on me" — or "You never remember to think of these things."

6. Communication messages vary in conscious thought. Shared meaning involves encoding and decoding verbal messages, nonverbal cues, and even visual images. Our messages may (1) occur **spontaneously**, (2) be **based on a script**, or (3) be **carefully constructed**.

7. Communication is guided by cultural norms. Culture is a system of shared beliefs, values, symbols, and behaviours. How messages are formed and interpreted depends on the cultural background of the participants. We must therefore be mindful of our communication behaviour when interacting with people from other cultures, so that we do not unintentionally communicate in ways that are culturally inappropriate or insensitive.

What is ethics? Why are ethical responsibilities important in public speaking?

Ethics is the branch of philosophy that deals with questions of **right and wrong in human behaviour**. In simple terms, ethics refers to the moral principles that guide the actions of individuals, groups, and societies. Ethical questions arise whenever we consider whether an action is moral or immoral, fair or unfair, just or unjust, honest or dishonest. These questions are not abstract — they arise daily in our personal, academic, and professional lives, and they are especially important in communication and public speaking.

Why ethics matters in public speaking:

- **Every discipline has ethical principles, and public speaking is no exception.** Whenever a speaker addresses an audience, ethical decisions are involved — what information to include, how to present it, and how honestly and fairly it is communicated.
- **Public speaking is a form of power.** Speakers have the ability to inform, persuade, influence beliefs, and shape public opinion. With that power comes responsibility. Ethical speakers use communication responsibly and with integrity, recognising that their words can have meaningful consequences for others.
- **A speech is not just an assignment.** For students, this means recognising that speeches are not merely tasks done for a grade, but acts of communication that can affect how other people think and act.
- **Ethical public speaking is a process, not a one-time event.** It does not begin when you stand up to speak. It begins the moment you start brainstorming your topic, and it continues through research, organising ideas, citing sources, using evidence honestly, and delivering the final presentation.
- **History shows speech can be misused.** In an ideal world all speakers would use their voices truthfully and for the good of society, but powerful communicators have sometimes manipulated audiences through misinformation, propaganda, and emotional appeals. Adolf Hitler is frequently cited as an example of how persuasive communication can be used unethically to influence public opinion and contribute to devastating consequences.

For students learning public speaking, this history underscores one lesson: **ethical communication is not optional**. By following the guidelines, students learn not only how to be effective speakers, but also how to be responsible, credible, and ethical communicators.

QUESTION 6 · CHAPTER 2 · HIGH-PROBABILITY QUESTION

Discuss the guidelines for ethical conduct in public speaking. How can a speaker improve his or her ethical standards?

Part A — The four guidelines for ethical conduct in public speaking

1. Be fully prepared for each speech. Ethical public speaking requires thorough preparation. Speakers have a responsibility both to themselves and to their audiences to deliver well-considered, accurate, and meaningful messages. Careful preparation enhances the quality and credibility of a speech, and it demonstrates respect for the audience's time and attention. Being prepared involves analysing the audience, organising ideas logically, developing effective visual aids, and rehearsing delivery. Most importantly, from an ethical standpoint, speakers must be well informed about their subject so as to avoid communicating inaccurate, misleading, or incomplete information.

EXAMPLE — A speaker presenting on health and nutrition has an ethical obligation to research credible scientific sources rather than rely on personal opinion or outdated information. If the speaker fails to prepare and gives incorrect dietary advice, the audience could make harmful decisions based on that misinformation.

2. Be honest and truthful. Honesty is the foundation of ethical public speaking. Speakers should never intentionally deceive their audiences through false statements, misleading claims, or the selective presentation of evidence. Ethical violations do not occur only when information is completely fabricated — they also occur when speakers **manipulate facts to create a misleading impression**. Subtle dishonesty includes altering statistics, quoting sources out of context, exaggerating evidence, and misrepresenting the credibility of sources.

EXAMPLE — A speaker arguing for a new public policy claims that "studies prove overwhelming support," while citing only one small survey and reporting only the favourable results. Even if the data is technically real, presenting it in a misleading way deceives the audience and undermines trust. Ethical speakers present evidence honestly, acknowledge limitations, and allow the audience to make informed judgements.

3. Do not plagiarise. Ethical communicators do not present others' ideas, words, or work as their own. In public speaking, plagiarism includes using quotations, statistics, or unique ideas without crediting the original source. It is unethical because it misleads the audience and fails to respect intellectual ownership. There are three types — **global**, **patchwork**, and **incremental** (see Question 7).

EXAMPLE — A student speaking on climate change uses a powerful statistic from a United Nations report. Instead of presenting it as her own research, she states aloud, "According to a 2023 United Nations report..." By citing the source she avoids plagiarism and maintains credibility and ethical integrity.

4. Show respect. Ethical communicators demonstrate respect for their audiences and for others by acknowledging the dignity, rights, and viewpoints of all individuals. They avoid language or behaviour that devalues, stereotypes, or degrades people or groups on the basis of characteristics such as religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity, gender, or culture. Respectful communicators engage differing perspectives thoughtfully and fairly, even when they strongly disagree, thereby promoting understanding, inclusivity, and constructive dialogue rather than division or harm.

EXAMPLE — A speaker discussing immigration policy may strongly oppose certain laws, but instead of using derogatory labels or generalisations about immigrants, he focuses on factual arguments and policy impacts. By addressing the issue without attacking or stereotyping a group, he shows respect for both the audience and the people being discussed.

Part B — How a speaker can improve his or her ethical standards

1. **Start early.** Most plagiarism and inaccuracy comes from last-minute panic. Beginning preparation early allows enough time to research, organise ideas, and develop an original speech rather than relying on someone else's work — this is the single best defence against global plagiarism.
2. **Identify your sources and take notes while researching.** The first step of ethical speech preparation is to take notes as you research your topic. Careful notes help you remember *where* you learned your information, and recalling your sources is precisely what enables speaker honesty.
3. **Cite sources orally during the speech** — "According to a 2023 United Nations report..." — and use citation tools such as BibMe or Citation Machine for written references.
4. **Use credible, up-to-date sources** instead of personal opinion or outdated material, and verify every statistic before saying it aloud.
5. **Present evidence fully and fairly.** Do not exaggerate, do not quote out of context, do not report only the favourable half of the data, and acknowledge the limitations of your evidence.
6. **Respect the audience and the people you speak about.** Avoid stereotypes, derogatory labels, and personal attacks; never expose, mock, or embarrass an identifiable individual.
7. **Analyse your audience and rehearse,** so that the message is accurate, clear, and appropriate for that audience and occasion.
3. **Treat ethics as a continuous process,** applied from topic selection right through to delivery — not as a rule you remember only at the last moment.

APPLYING IT: THE "ALEX" SCENARIO FROM CLASS

Alex prepared his obesity speech at the last minute, copied several paragraphs from a health website without citing it, exaggerated an unverified statistic ("almost everyone who is obese will develop serious diseases before age 40"), and mocked an identifiable classmate. He therefore violated **three of the four guidelines**: he was not fully prepared, he was not honest and truthful, he plagiarised, and he failed to show respect. Every improvement listed in Part B is a direct answer to one of Alex's mistakes.

QUESTION 7 · CHAPTER 2

What is plagiarism? Explain the three types of plagiarism with examples, and state how it can be avoided.

Plagiarism means presenting another person's ideas, words, or work as one's own. In public speaking it includes using quotations, statistics, or unique ideas without crediting the original source. It is unethical because it **misleads the audience** and **fails to respect intellectual ownership**. There are three types.

TYPE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE
Global plagiarism	Taking an entire speech or a major portion of a work from a single source and presenting it as your own. The most obvious form.	A student finds a speech on the internet, or borrows a former speech from a roommate, and recites it word for word. Or: submitting an essay you found online as your own.
Patchwork plagiarism	Piecing together phrases, sentences, or sections from multiple sources without citation, and mixing them into a "new" work. Copying from several sources is no less unethical than copying from one.	You write an essay by taking sentences from various articles and putting them together with little or no change to the wording, and you do not properly cite those sources.
Incremental plagiarism	Using small portions of someone else's work — phrases, sentences, statistics, or ideas — without appropriate citation. Each instance seems minor, but repeated use of uncited material still misrepresents the work as original.	Dropping an uncited statistic and one memorable line from an article into an otherwise original speech.

How to avoid plagiarism:

- **Begin preparing early.** Enough time to research, organise ideas, and develop an original speech is the best way to avoid global plagiarism.
- **Identify your sources.** The first step of ethical speech preparation is to take notes as you research. Careful notes help you remember where you learned your information, and recalling your sources is what enables speaker honesty.
- **Cite properly, aloud and in writing.** Audiences do not expect speakers to present completely original ideas; they expect speakers to **research the topic carefully and present information responsibly**, giving proper credit to every source used — including the small ones.

QUESTION 8 · CHAPTER 2

What are the guidelines for ethical listening?

Ethical listening requires the same level of responsibility as ethical speaking. Just as speakers are obliged to prepare, listeners have a duty to be courteous, attentive, and supportive. There are two guidelines.

1. Be courteous and attentive. In a classroom setting, listening is part of a shared learning experience in which students depend on one another. Ethical listeners come to class prepared to listen actively and to learn from their classmates' speeches. Being attentive also means being aware of the **verbal and nonverbal feedback** you send to the speaker: facial expressions, eye contact, posture, and reactions can significantly affect a speaker's confidence and composure. Ethical listeners recognise the influence they have, and choose to show encouragement and respect rather than distraction or discouragement.

EXAMPLE — When a classmate is delivering a speech, an ethical listener puts away the phone, maintains eye contact, and avoids side conversations. Even if the speaker appears nervous, the listener nods or smiles to show engagement. This supportive behaviour helps the speaker feel confident and respected.

2. Maintain free and open expression of ideas. Ethical listening involves being open to a wide range of viewpoints and allowing speakers to express their ideas freely. Listeners should strive to understand a speaker's perspective even when it differs from their own beliefs or opinions. Respectful listening **does not require agreement**; it requires fairness, open-mindedness, and a willingness to consider alternative viewpoints without judgement or hostility. Dismissing, interrupting, or mocking a speaker because of differing opinions undermines this ethical responsibility.

EXAMPLE — During a class discussion on a controversial topic, a student who strongly disagrees with the speaker's position does not interrupt or react negatively. She allows the speaker to finish, listens carefully, and responds thoughtfully during the discussion period.

APPLYING IT: THE "MARIA" SCENARIO FROM CLASS

Maria had spent weeks preparing her renewable-energy presentation. But her classmates talked quietly among themselves, scrolled through social media, avoided eye contact, and did not answer when she asked a question. As a result Maria became more nervous and struggled to stay confident. This is **unethical listening**: the audience failed to be courteous and attentive, and their nonverbal feedback directly damaged a well-prepared speaker. It shows that a speech is a shared responsibility between speaker and audience.

QUESTION 9 · CHAPTER 3 · HIGH-PROBABILITY QUESTION

What is nonverbal communication? Explain the THREE types of nonverbal communication.

Nonverbal communication consists of all the messages we send in ways that transcend spoken or written words. More specifically, nonverbal messages are the cues we send with our **body, voice, and appearance** to **support, contradict, or even replace** a verbal message. They are extremely important: **65–90% of the meaning in a face-to-face interaction comes from nonverbal messages**. The meaning we assign to any utterance is based on our interpretation of *both* the verbal and the nonverbal messages that accompany it, so interpreting nonverbal messages accurately is critical to understanding and responding appropriately to what others say.

TYPE 1 — Use of Body (Kinesics)

Kinesics is the technical name for what and how body motions communicate. It looks at how posture, hand movements, eye contact, and facial expressions contribute to communication, and it plays a huge role in public speaking because it can either **enhance or undermine** your message. It has five elements:

- **Gestures** — movements of the hands, arms, and fingers that accompany or replace a verbal message. In a speech they describe or emphasise what you are saying, refer to presentational aids, and keep the audience engaged. Just as we rehearse our words, we must practise gestures. The best gestures are **natural** and reinforce what you are saying; avoid gestures that distract the audience or change the meaning of your words.
- **Eye contact** — the most important way to engage an audience is by looking at them. Eye contact builds a connection and shows confidence. A speaker who constantly reads notes, looks at their feet or their visuals, and never looks up communicates that they are nervous and unprepared; a speaker who looks at every part of the audience confidently wins them over.
- **Facial expression** — using the facial muscles to communicate. Expressions animate a speech by enhancing the words you say, much like gestures. It is essential that your facial expression **reinforces** the message you are trying to get across.
- **Posture** — how we position the body. Posture communicates attentiveness, respect, and even dominance. An **upright stance** communicates confidence, authority, and credibility, whereas speakers who **slouch** may be perceived as lacking self-confidence and as not caring about the topic, the audience, or the occasion.
- **Body movement** — changing body position. It may be **motivated** (movement that helps clarify meaning, such as stepping forward to emphasise an important idea or moving to refer to a presentational aid) or **unmotivated** (movement that distracts listeners from the point being made). Effective speakers engage only in motivated movement.

TYPE 2 — Use of Voice (Paralanguage)

Paralanguage refers to the vocal aspects of communication that go beyond the actual words spoken. These vocal cues provide a wealth of information about the speaker's **emotions, intentions, and level of sincerity** — information that may not be evident from the words themselves. It has four elements:

- **Pitch** — the highness or lowness of vocal tone. We raise and lower our pitch to emphasise ideas and emotion, and to signal a question; we sometimes raise it when we feel nervous or afraid. *If someone speaks in a flat, monotonous way, the message seems dull or insincere even when the content is interesting; if you speak with energy and varied pitch, the audience feels engaged and excited.*
- **Rate** — the speed at which a person speaks. Controlling rate is one of the most challenging things a speaker must do. Do not rush through the material, and use **pauses for emphasis**. Speaking too quickly makes the audience tune out, and rapid speech can make you seem less credible and harder to understand.
- **Intonation** — the variety, melody, or inflection in the voice. Vocal variety is the key to keeping the audience connected. Without it, the voice comes across as **monotone** (absent of pitch variety) and the audience disengages.
- **Articulation** — how clearly the speaker pronounces words, using the **articulators**: the tongue, teeth, and lips. When sounds are slurred together or dropped, the word may not be understood. In public speaking a listener cannot request a repeat, so poor articulation makes listeners tune out.

A speaker who adjusts tone for emphasis, speaks with confidence, and uses pauses effectively is far more persuasive and compelling than one who speaks monotonously and without emotional variation.

TYPE 3 — Physical Appearance

When we meet new people, we are likely to form our **first impression** of them based on how they are dressed and groomed. We can therefore influence how others perceive us through our clothing and grooming choices when speaking publicly. A neatly groomed, professional appearance sends an important message about the speaker's **commitment to the topic and the occasion**. The "right" clothes for a speaking situation depend on your personal taste, preferences, and intentions, as well as the situation, the audience's expectations, and the nature of the event. Three rules of thumb:

- Consider the **audience and the occasion**.
- Consider your **topic and purpose**.
- **Avoid extremes**.

QUESTION 10 · CHAPTER 3

Explain the **FOUR** characteristics of nonverbal communication with examples.

1. Nonverbal communication is inevitable. The phrase "**We cannot NOT communicate**" captures the essence of this characteristic. If you are in the presence of someone else, your nonverbal messages — whether intentional or not — are communicating.

EXAMPLE — When a student yawns and stares off into the distance during class, the teacher notices the behaviour and assigns meaning to it: boredom, fatigue, or even disrespect. Meanwhile the student may be completely unaware of all the messages his behaviour is sending.

2. Nonverbal communication is the primary conveyer of emotions. We interpret how others feel about what they are communicating almost entirely from their nonverbal messages. In fact, **about 90% of the emotional meaning** of a message is conveyed nonverbally.

EXAMPLE — Your friend frowns, clenches her fists, and forcefully says, "I am NOT angry!" You ignore the verbal message and believe the contradicting nonverbal messages — which communicate that she is in fact very angry.

3. Nonverbal communication is multi-channelled. We perceive meaning from a **combination** of different nonverbal behaviours at once — posture, gestures, facial expression, vocal pitch and rate, and appearance. The fact that nonverbal communication is multi-channelled is one reason people are more likely to believe the **nonverbal** message when nonverbal behaviours contradict the verbal one.

EXAMPLE — A parent observes the child's failure to maintain eye contact and his bowed head, and decides the child is lying when he says he did not hit his sibling.

4. Nonverbal communication is ambiguous. Very few nonverbal messages mean the same thing to everyone. The meaning of one nonverbal behaviour can vary based on **culture, gender, and even context or situation**.

EXAMPLE — In the dominant American culture, direct eye contact is understood as a sign of respect. In some other cultures, however, direct eye contact might be interpreted as disrespectful. The meaning of the same nonverbal message can also differ from one situation to another.

One-Page Revision Sheet

Every list you may be asked to reproduce, plus a memory hook for each.

Chapter 1 — Communication Perspectives

CONCEPT	THE LIST
Encoding	Putting thoughts and feelings into words and nonverbal behaviour. (You package meaning.)
Decoding	Interpreting another person's message — through the receiver's own frame, not the sender's.
Canned plan	A mental library of learned strategies for a situation. It contains scripts — the actual text of what to say and do.
5 contexts PSHPC	Physical (setting, noise, lighting, proximity) · Social (the existing relationship) · Historical (past interactions) · Psychological (mood, attitudes, beliefs) · Cultural (values, rituals, assumptions) Memory hook: <i>Please Send Her Personal Card.</i>
7 characteristics	Has a purpose · is continuous · is irreversible · is situated · is indexical · varies in conscious thought · is guided by cultural norms Memory hook: <i>"Purpose Continues Irreversibly — a Situated Index that Varies by Culture."</i>

Chapter 2 — Ethics & Public Speaking

CONCEPT	THE LIST
Ethics	The branch of philosophy dealing with right and wrong in human behaviour ; the moral principles that guide our actions.
4 ethical speaking guidelines PHPR	Be fully Prepared · Be Honest and truthful · Do not Plagiarise · Show Respect
3 types of plagiarism GPI	Global (whole work from one source) · Patchwork (stitched from many sources) · Incremental (small uncited bits)
How to avoid it	Start early · take notes & identify your sources · cite orally in the speech · use credible sources · present evidence fairly
2 ethical listening guidelines	Be courteous and attentive · Maintain free and open expression of ideas

Chapter 3 — Nonverbal Messages

CONCEPT	THE LIST
Definition	All messages sent beyond spoken/written words — cues from body, voice, appearance that support, contradict, or replace a verbal message. 65–90% of meaning in face-to-face interaction is nonverbal.
3 types BVA	Body = Kinesics → gestures, eye contact, facial expression, posture, body movement (motivated vs. unmotivated) Voice = Paralanguage → pitch, rate, intonation, articulation Appearance = Physical Appearance → consider audience & occasion, consider topic & purpose, avoid extremes
4 characteristics IEMA	Inevitable ("we cannot NOT communicate") · primary conveyer of Emotions (~90% of emotional meaning) · Multi-channelled (many cues at once) · Ambiguous (varies by culture, gender, situation)

EXAM-HALL ORDER OF WORK

1. Read the speech topic **first** — write the note card grid (§1.2) on your rough sheet while your mind is fresh.
2. Answer the board questions you know best, using the **headings and numbered lists** from Part 2. Examiners find the marks faster when the structure is visible.
3. Always add the **example** after the definition. Every list in this pack has one; use it.
4. Come back to the speech and write it out in full, with the bold labels (Attention-grabber / Thesis / Point 1 / Explanation / Conclusion).